The Megaphone

ECCO EQUIPMENT CORPORATION

August 2018 | Volume 12, Issue 2

ECCO Helps with Construction of Modern Nevada Community

As the economy begins to create jobs it also creates the need for more workers and families in the Las Vegas Area. ECCO Equipment has had the pleasure of supplying Meadow Valley Contractors the equipment needed to prepare for what could be the next booming community in Southern Nevada: Coyote Springs, located about 45 minutes north of Las Vegas. Meadow Valley has spent the last 18 months moving more than 1.5 million yards of dirt and building one of the largest flood retention basins in southern Nevada. They are also in the process of completing a new waterline that will help supply this future community. The Coyote Springs master plan would include about 2,700 homes, schools, shopping and an 18-hole golf course.

Rob Engert, Dale Darland and **Jay Haggerty** deserve special recognition for keeping more than 15 machines in good working order under difficult conditions. ECCO supplied 1 Cat D10R, 1 Cat D9R, 6 Cat 631 scrapers, 4 40-ton articulating trucks, 2 water pulls and several excavators. Given the production needs of the customer and the heat of the Vegas summer, our mechanics were amazing.

It has been a pleasure working Voy Matheson and others from Meadow Valley Contractors. We look forward to working with them as they continue to build infrastructure for this new community.

Robin Ready for Retirement

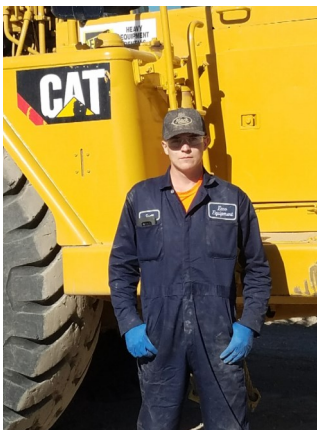
On Friday, July 27th, the Santa Ana office said goodbye to Robin Weed, who is retiring after an astounding 28 years at ECCO Equipment. A party out in the yard and a few speeches of all the good things Robin has done at ECCO filled the agenda for the celebration. His mentorship and years of experience in this business will be missed, but we are happy for him to move into the next phase of his life. Let's hope the next generation of ECCO employees can fill Robin's large shoes!

New Faces

Rene Castro Rene came to ECCO after spending 14 years at a feedlot as a jack of all trades. He is originally from Texas and has 9 kids. Rene enjoys spending his time with his grand kids and browsing estate sales with his wife.

Joseph Matthews Back in May of 2000, Joe was hired as a yard man in Santa Ana. His strong work ethic and aptitude helped him quickly move to apprentice and ultimately into a "home grown" Oiler/Greaser in just a few years. Unfortunately, we had to lay off Joe (and others) at the depths of the Great Recession. Joe continued to keep in touch with his old friends here at ECCO and this June we were happy to rehire him as a replacement for a retiring HDR (see above story). He will resume his career working from the Riverside yard as the Branch 4 & 14 Oiler/Greaser! Congratulations Joseph, way to persevere!

Ralph Martinez Ralph is the newest member of the Stockton branch. He was born in Fairfield, CA at Travis Air Force base where both of his parents served. He enjoys walking his dog and going off-roading with his buddies. He wants to develop his work skills and knowledge in the heavy equipment field.



Scott Pethtel Please welcome Scott Pethtel to the ECCO team. Scott was hired on as the yard man at our Utah branch June 1st. Scott is 25 years old, has two small children and has lived in Utah for the last 10 years. He enjoys the construction industry, heavy equipment and working with his hands.

Reign Dakota Issa Jr. Issa Ntawuruhunga, a member of the Williston branch, has introduced his new son, Reign, to the company. He was born June 25, 2018, and we are excited to see the ECCO family grow even bigger!

ECCO "Sponsors" Charity Golf Tournament Near Pittsburgh

By Dennis Kenavey Back in my younger years, I was a pretty good football player. In high school I played on defense, offence, the kicking team, the receiving team, and I was the punter on the punting team! At the time I had the all-time best punting average in the WPIAL (Western Pennsylvania Interscholastic Athletic League) where some guys named Montana, Marino, Kelly, Namath, Dorsett, Blanda and Ditka all played high school football. Although some of the great players got to go to big schools like Pitt, Penn State or WVU, a lot of the kids would go to smaller local schools like Slippery Rock, Grove City, Carnegie Mellon, Duquesne, Point Park, Bethany, and Westminster. Anyway, the starting quarterback for my high school team was a good friend of mine named Steve Kraus. Steve had one of the best arms I've ever seen and ended up at Westminster College on a full scholarship. At the second game of the season during his freshman year, the starting QB got injured and the coach put Steve in. With Steve as QB, the Westminster Titans would not lose a game for the rest of the season and for the next three years! He was undefeated in college! At the end of Steve's college career he was drafted by Tom Landry and the Dallas cowboys as a high round pick because Landry was looking for a third guy to back up Roger Staubach and Danny White. It came down to Steve Kraus and Gary Hogeboom for the third spot. Unfortunately for Steve, Gary had a better camp and Steve had to pack it up and head back home to Pittsburgh where he became the local distributer for Gould's pumps and valves. He was very successful with his business. Steve and I kept in touch over the years and I would always make sure to see him every time my wife Amy and I would go back to Pittsburgh for a visit. Unfortunately on May 1, 2010 Steve died suddenly. He was in his hot tub with his wife Janice, Amy's best friend all through grade school and high school. Janice got out and went into the house, and when she came back out 20 minutes later Steve was dead from a heart attack. I was in shock knowing what a great athlete he was. A few of my high school friends organized a Steve Kraus memorial golf tournament every year to raise money for a scholarship in Steve's name for kids from Brentwood who want to attend Westminster College. One of my old high school buddies who played on the football team with me and Steve is Dr. Frank Cappetta who organizes the tournament with a few of our old classmates. Frank emailed me with the itinerary for this year and they were looking for hole sponsors. Most of them were sponsored by guys who owned local businesses that graduated from Brentwood high school. Being the good guy that I am, I thought I would sponsor a hole. I didn't want to just put my name on the banner on the hole so I decided to go ahead and put ECCO on as the sponsor! They raised $15,000.00 for the scholarship fund and Steve's sister Leslie who was a good friend of Amy presented the check to a kid who graduated from Brentwood High School. (Leslie worked at the Pentagon and was working there on 9-11). So this summer, on a hole on an obscure golf course outside of Pittsburgh, PA, a bunch of guys were teeing off next to a sign that had ECCO Equipment with a picture of the 623K that I took on it! So now you know why ECCO has a sign in Pennsylvania!

New Eye Protection Areas

Please comply with the eye protection areas designated in each yard.
Envision keeping your vision.

ECCO Picnic in So Cal

Old Timers

Young Timers

Rick and Larry 30 Year Party

On May 30, Region 100 held a luncheon to celebrate a major milestone for two of our employees: **Rick Johnson** and **Larry Lozo** both eclipsed 30 years of service at ECCO (Rick will soon reach 31). Since the founding of the company, we have had only 4 employees who have served over 30 years. (Larry, Rick, **Veronica Mendoza** & **Ray Stubbs**) To commemorate the occasion, we commissioned the limited production of specialty 30-year Veteran ECCO caps for these cornerstone employees. Also, as in the past, we named machines for the two new club members. "Rick" is a new 2018 CAT D8T dozer, & "Larry" is a new 2018 DEERE 650K LT dozer. The machines will be decaled with the employee's name! Let's hope these machines work as long and as hard as their namesakes! Congratulations to all of our veteran employees past & present!

Rick Johnson

Larry Lozo

ECCO Work Anniversaries

May • June • July • August

Name	Position	Locations	Years	Name	Position	Location	Years
Johnson, Richard	Mechanic	Santa Ana	31	Novak, Dave	Regional Mgr	Santa Ana	15
Lozo, Larry	Mechanic	Santa Ana	30	Andrea, Larry	Mechanic	Sacramento	15
Rhodes, Lee	Mechanic	Coachella	28	Cahoon, James	Mechanic	Lindon	14
Barker, Lane	Service Mgr	Santa Ana	22	Avila, Jeff	Asst. Service Mgr	Visalia	12
Scaduto, Frank	Regional Mgr	Visalia	22	Dahlstrom, Hal	Field Rep	San Diego	7
Serrato, Raul	Mechanic	Visalia	21	Kenavey, Dennis	Field Rep	Stockton	5
Sisco, James	Mechanic	Visalia	20	Crose, Russell	Field Rep	Visalia	3
Mayfield, James	Operator	Santa Ana	17	Robertson, Patrick	Yard Hand	Phoenix	3
Chadwick, Scott	Mechanic	Stockton	16	Siu, Tony	Sr. Staff Acct	Santa Ana	2
Waldron, Jason	Mechanic	Riverside	16	Welsh, Peter	Mechanic	Williston	2
Heim, Greg	Mechanic	Stockton	16				